



TIPS & TRICKS

Finding out a file's size before initiating an expensive download

With super-fast connectivity, we often download gigabytes before realising that a file is bigger than our budget. To find out the size of the download, install *curl* and *gawk*. Then fill a local file *sizer.sh* with the following commands:

```
#!/usr/bin/env bash
echo -n "Enter full download URL (Ctrl-Shift-V to paste): "
read FULLURL; RET=0
while [[ RET -eq 0 ]]; do
    LEN=$(curl -Ls --head $FULLURL | grep -i "Content-
Length" | tail -1)
    TYPE=$(curl -Ls --head $FULLURL | grep -i "Content-
type" | tail -1)
    grep "text" <(echo $TYPE) >/dev/null 2>&1
    RET=$?
    if [[ RET -ne 0 ]]
    then
        tr -dc '[:print:]' <<<$TYPE; echo
        echo $(tr -dc '[:print:]' <<<$LEN)" bytes";
    exit
    fi
    DOMAIN=$(echo $FULLURL|cut -d/ -f1-3)
    OLDURL=$FULLURL
    FULLURL=$DOMAIN$(curl -Ls --get -r 0-10240 $FULLURL |
grep -i "http-equiv" | \
grep -i "url=" | awk 'BEGIN {FS="url="} {print $2}') |
cut -d \" -f 1 | cut -d \" -f 1)
    if [ "$OLDURL" == "$FULLURL" ]
    then
        echo "Download size cannot be determined";
    exit
    fi
done
```

Make it executable once by using the

following command:

```
chmod +x ./sizer.sh
```

Run it with *./sizer.sh* and supply your URL to query its size.

—A. Datta,
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A useful tool called Tilda

We often want to access the terminal to execute some command or to see the progress of some job running inside the terminal; to do this, we need to switch from using *Ctrl+tab*. For those who dislike switching, there is Tilda. It is a Linux terminal with no borders and is hidden from the desktop till a key is pressed. You can install it using the following command on Debian and similar systems.

```
sudo apt-get install tilda
```

Once installed, you can launch and configure Tilda by right-clicking on it and then choose *Preferences*. Assign a less frequently used key combination as a shortcut to launch Tilda so that it doesn't interfere with your regular shortcut keys. Tilda is very useful when you are following some tutorial and want to code simultaneously while reading it.

—Amar Shukla,
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Easily restrict untrusted applications using Linux namespaces

Firejail is a SUID sandbox program that reduces the risk of security breaches by restricting the running environment of untrusted applications. It does this by